

same data type, such as integers, strings, characters, etc. Using arrays makes much more efficient use of memory than would have been the case if each value in the result had been assigned its own variable.

6.3.3 ASP

Active Server Pages. A Microsoft technology, ASP is a scripted language that is processed by the Web server when a user accesses the Web page. ASP pages can be quickly identified by their extension .asp, or .aspx, the more recent version of ASP. Like other scripting languages used on the Web, the primary aim of ASP is to be able to handle dynamic content, frequently-changing information, and accessing other information systems like databases. ASP is based on the Visual Basic programming language.

6.3.4 ASP.NET

This is a collection of Web development tools from Microsoft that includes software development programs like Visual Studio.NET and Visual Web Developer. These tools help programmers create dynamic Web sites by using a visual interface and using methods like drag and drop. Often looked on as the next “version” of ASP (Active Server Pages) technology, ASP.NET’s support is not limited to just Visual Basic.NET. It also supports Jscript.Net and open source languages like Python and Perl. ASP.NET is built on the .NET Framework. For an ASP.NET site to function properly, it should run on a Web server that supports ASP.NET. By far, the Web server that offers the best support for ASP.NET is the IIS (Internet Information Server) Web Server from Microsoft.

6.3.5 BASIC

Beginners All-Purpose Symbolic Instruction Code. Invented in the mid-1960s, BASIC was meant to be a programming language for beginners and students to quickly learn the concepts of programming. Since then, however, it has evolved into a robust language in its own right, and today there are versions of BASIC that are used to develop application software. The most widely-used version of BASIC is Visual Basic from Microsoft.